

Review of Block ciphers: Authenticated Encryption

Study reference: Aumasson, chapter 8

Recap: encryption does not guarantee integrity!

→ **Confidentiality: semantic security against CPA**

- ⇒ Encryption secure against eavesdropping only
- ⇒ **NOT secure against active attackers (see next 5 slides!!)**

→ **Integrity: unforgeability under CCA**

- ⇒ But messages remain in plaintext

→ **Authenticated Encryption:**

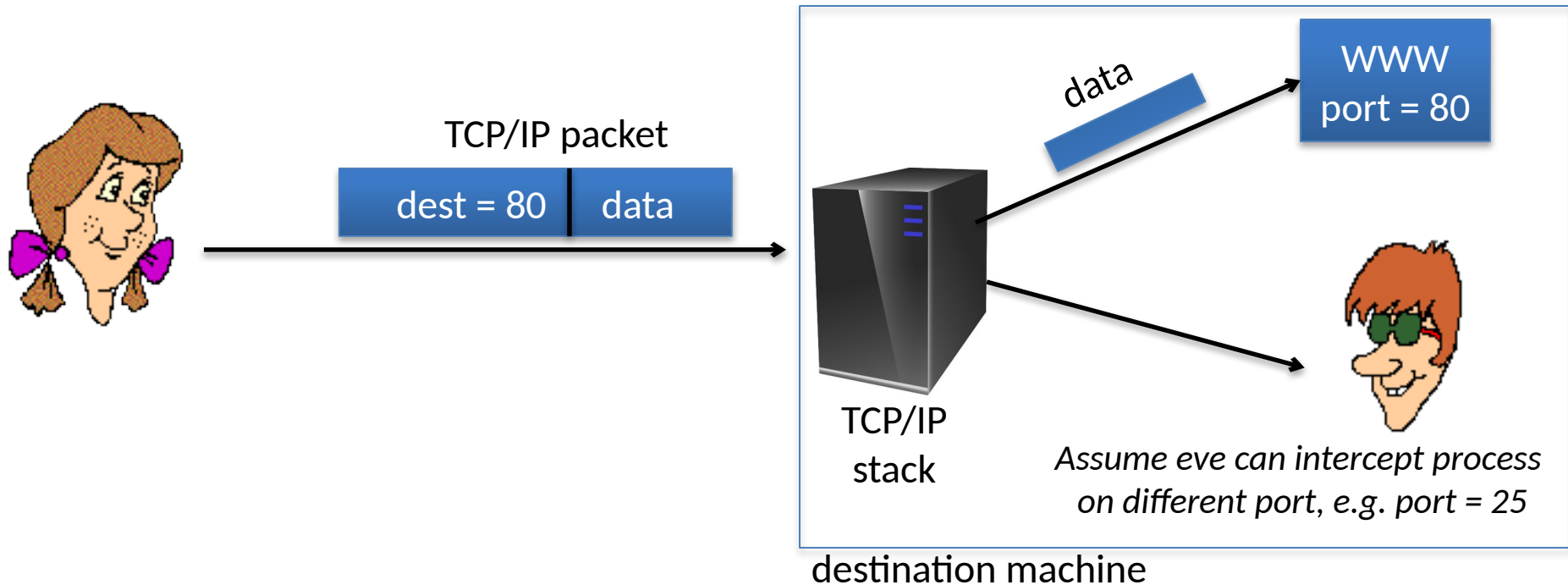
- ⇒ Cipher designed to be secure against active attacks (tampering)
- ⇒ Ensure both confidentiality and integrity

**Indeed: tampering attacks CAN
also break confidentiality!**

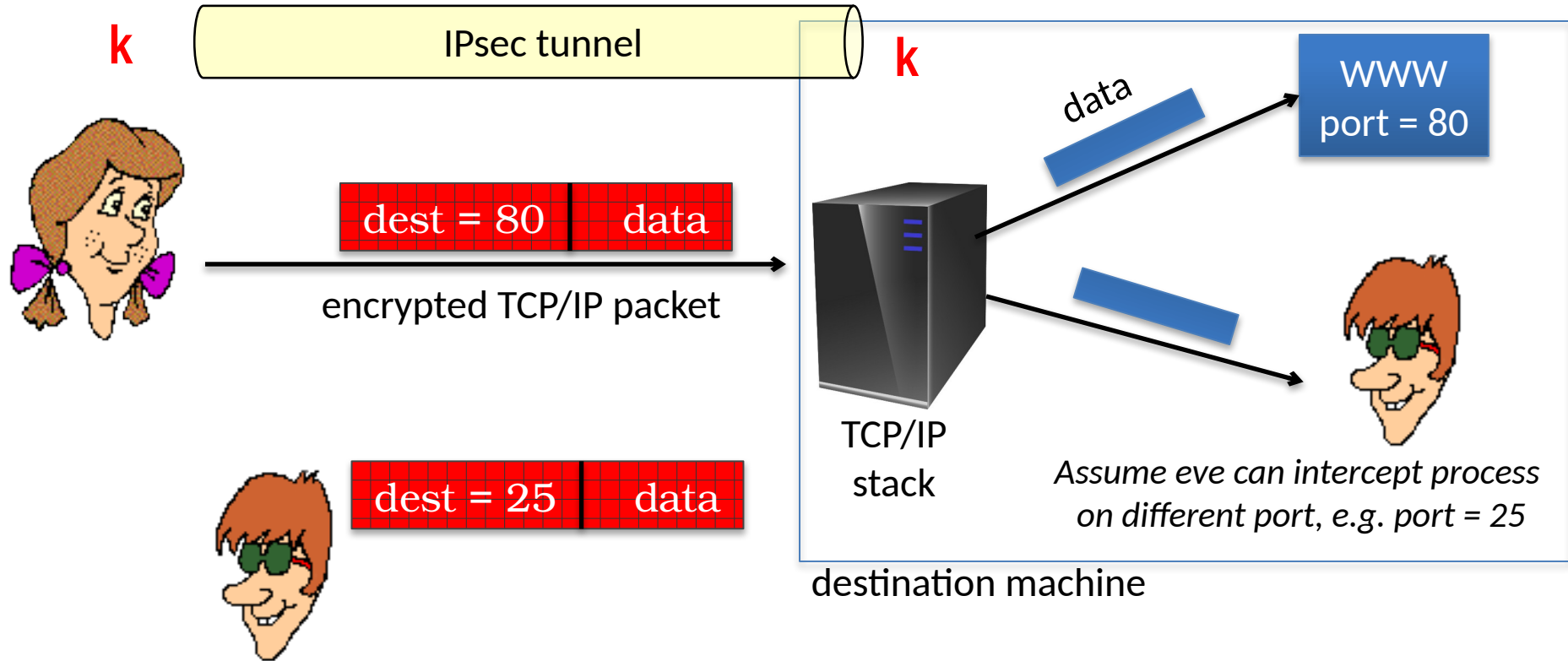
**→ Two illustrative examples in the
next slides**

→ (credits to Dan Boneh's class)

Example 1



Example 1

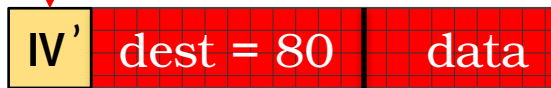
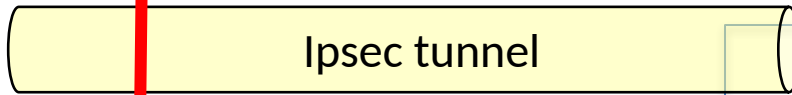


If attacker could just change port...

Could then read data in clear!!

TRIVIAL, with CBC encryption!!!

Example 1



CBC-encrypted TCP/IP packet



IV

dest=80

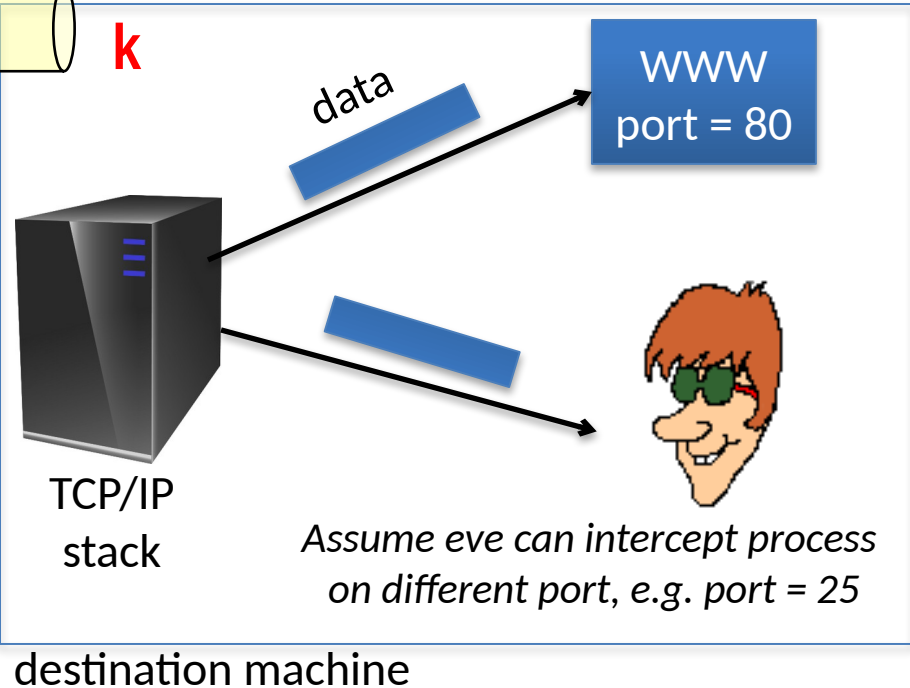


$IV \oplus \text{dest}=80$

$K \rightarrow$

PRP

dest=80



Test:
 $IV' = ??$

$$IV' = IV \oplus \text{dest}=80 \oplus \text{dest}=25$$



Now the SAME previous ciphertext decrypt
to a new plaintext where port=25!!

I'm not yet convinced!

→ Too strong (?) attacker model!

⇒ Attacker has access to the backend

→ And you always use CBC in your examples!

⇒ Perhaps CTR is not vulnerable??



**See next slide an example of
CCA against CTR!**

Example 2:

Attacker has only network access;

Remote terminal app: each keystroke encrypted with CTR mode



16 bit TCP checksum

1 byte
keystroke

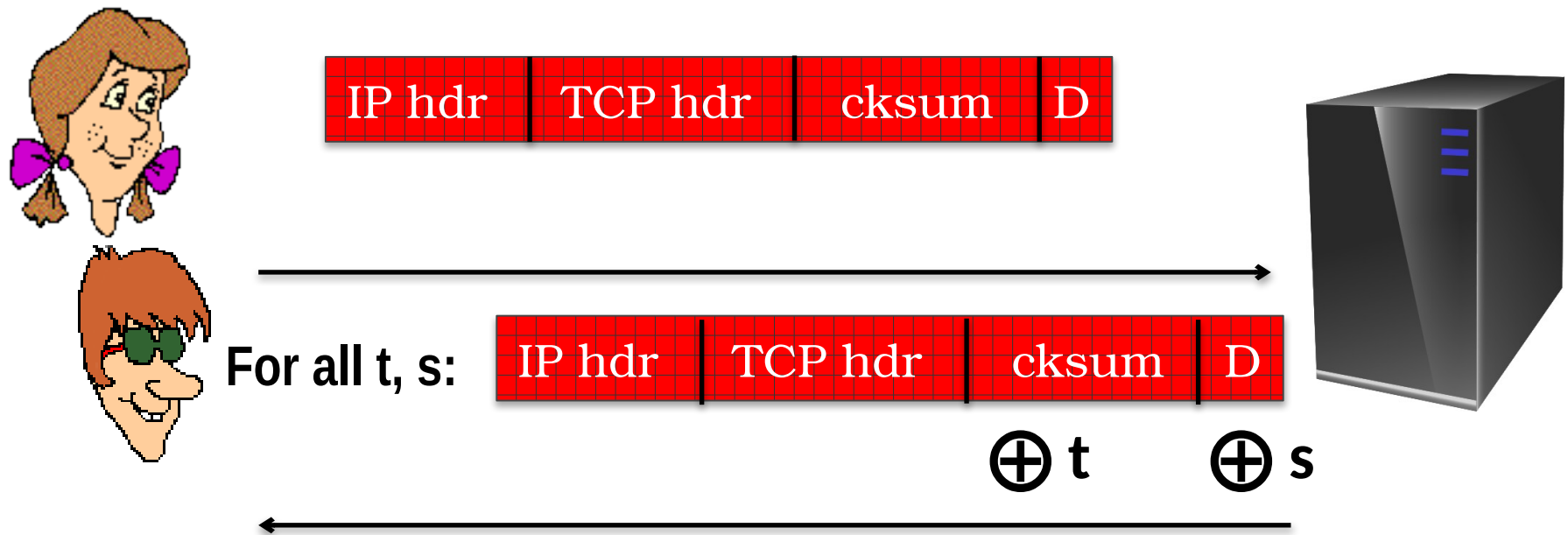


FACT: TCP/IP stack processes only valid packets
→ TCP will ACK only packets with correct cksum
(let's use this as an oracle!!)

Example 2:

Attacker has only network access;

Remote terminal app: each keystroke encrypted with CTR mode



ACK if valid checksum, nothing otherwise

**MANY (!) valid equations: $\{\text{checksum}(\text{hdr}, D \oplus s) = t \oplus \text{checksum}(\text{hdr}, D)\}$
hdr often known, {cksum, D} unknown $\rightarrow$ may be solved!**

Take home

CPA security cannot guarantee secrecy under active attacks.

Only use one of two modes:

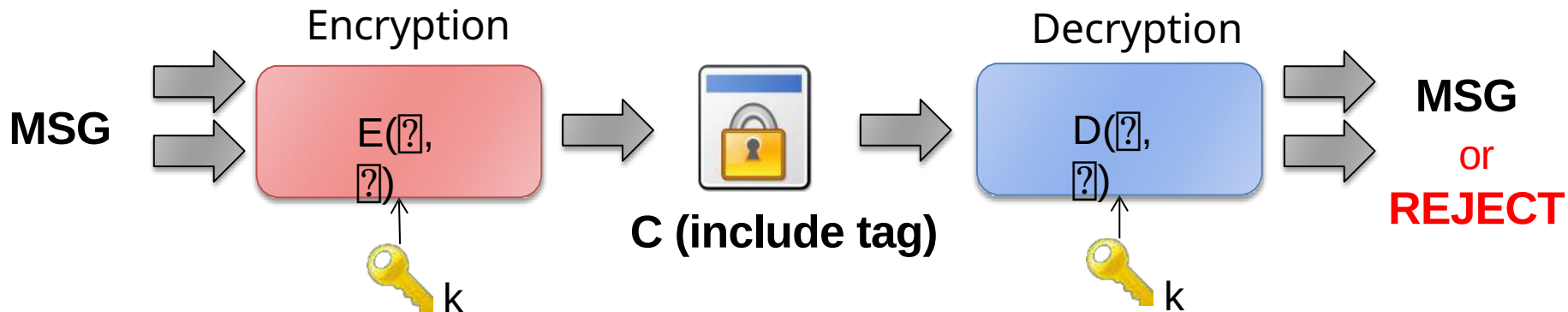
➔ **If message needs integrity but no confidentiality:**

use a MAC

➔ **If message needs both integrity and confidentiality:**

use authenticated encryption modes

Authenticated Encryption



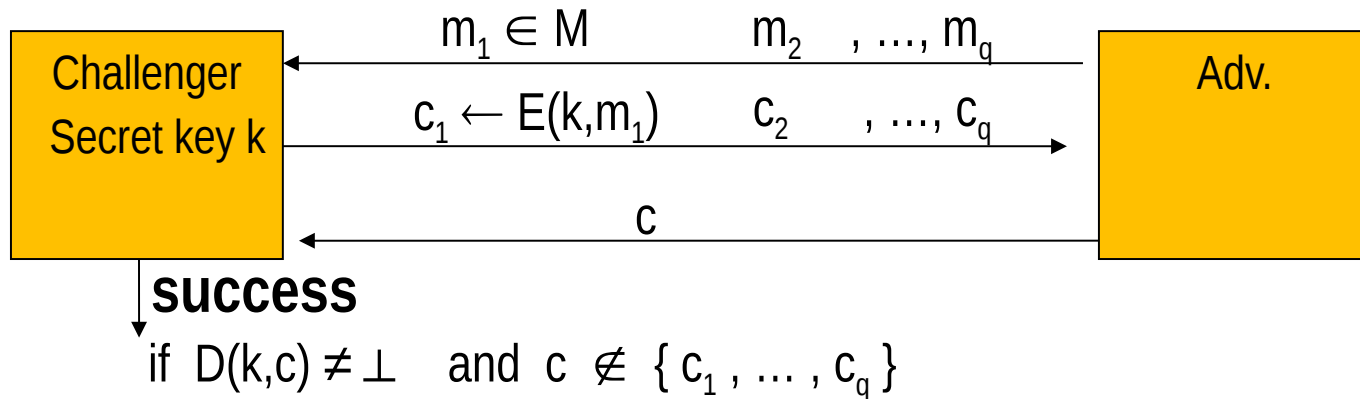
*Unlike standard ENC which always returns a msg,
AE may output a “REJECT”*

AE fundamentally stronger than basic cipher:
decrypts ONLY IF authentication tag is valid.
→ *Prevents attacker from performing CCA*

Security definition

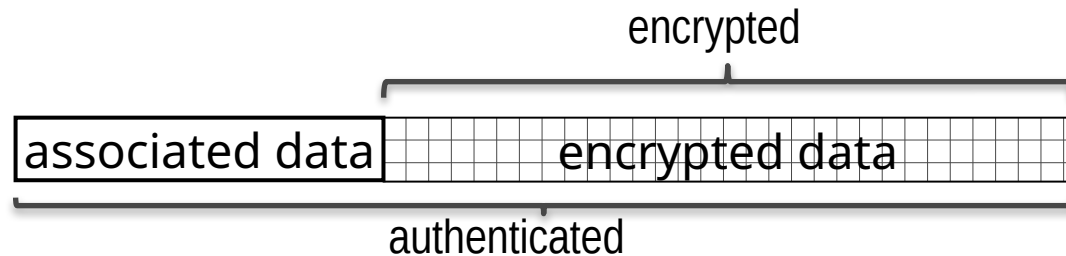
→ **AE is secure if:**

1. is semantically secure under CPA
2. Guarantees **ciphertext integrity**



ciphertext integrity (informally): if probability of success is negligible
(note: success even if forged c decrypting to completely random msg!!!)

AEAD: AE with Associated Data



- ➔ **Associated data: often packet hdr**
 - ⇒ hdr must usually remain in plaintext
- ➔ **Extreme cases also frequent**
 - ⇒ No associated data → CCA-secure encryption
 - ⇒ No encrypted data → secure MAC
- ➔ **Now should be clear why modern protocols only use AEAD (e.g. TLSv1.3)**
 - ⇒ If no AEAD, then use Encrypt-then-MAC, also CCA-secure

Design choices for AEAD

→ Structure

- ⇒ Two-layer = first encrypt and then MAC (e.g. AES-GCM)
- ⇒ One-layer = all in one (e.g. OCB → faster than GCM)

→ Performance

- ⇒ First encrypt then MAC may require two pass → slow
- ⇒ «full» parallelizability: hard
 - authenticity check requires «all» data!
- ⇒ **Streamability (= online cipher): one pass**

→ Functional requirements

- ⇒ Where to place Associated Data? Before? After? Any mix?

→ Misuse resistance

- ⇒ How robust is AEAD **when IV is reused?**

AES-GCM: Galois Counter Mode

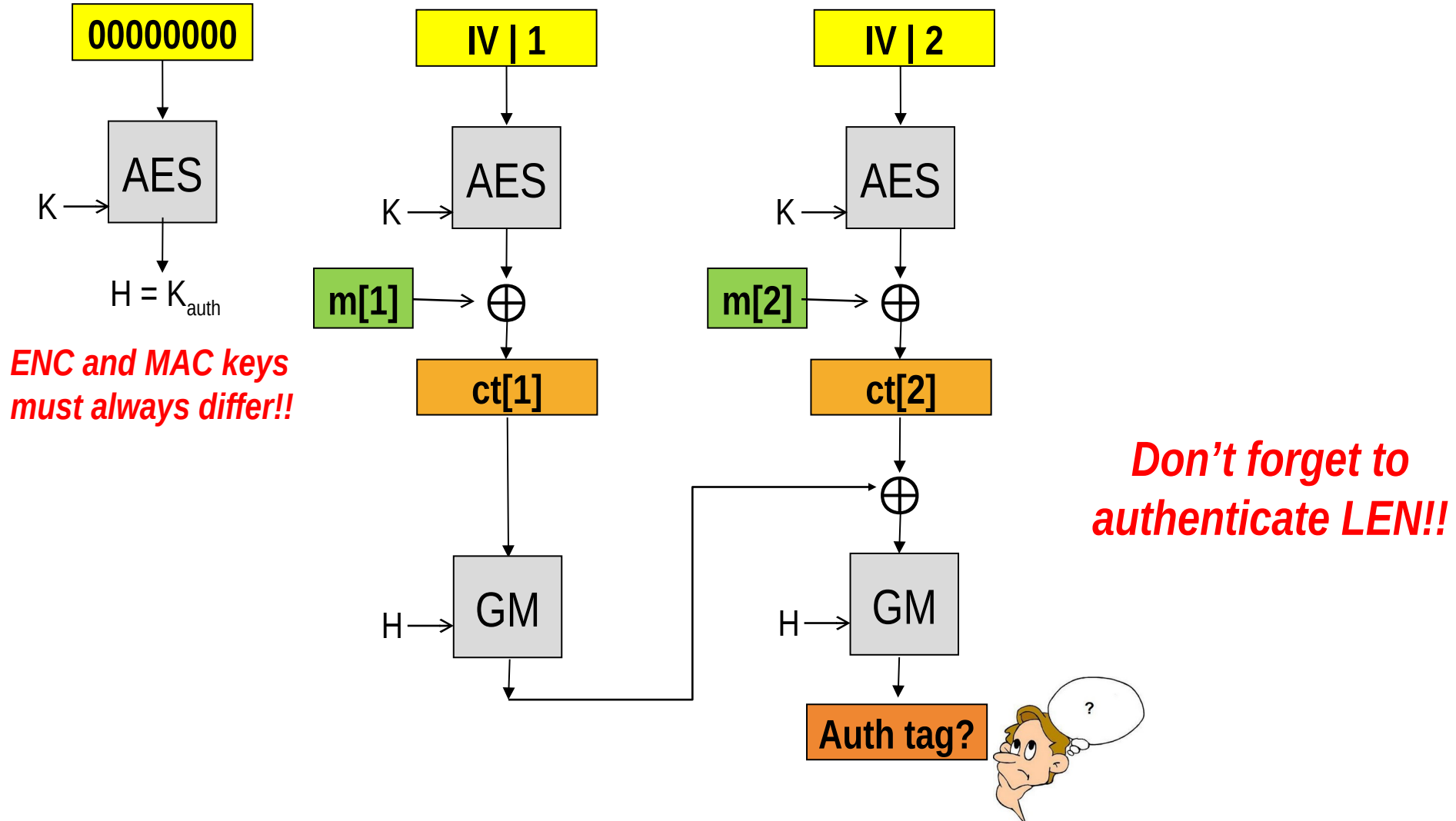
➔ **First standardized algorithm**

- ⇒ NIST SP 800 38D recommendation
- ⇒ Used in most security protocols (IPsec, TLS, ...)
 - ➔ (though not used in WiFi → AES-CCM)

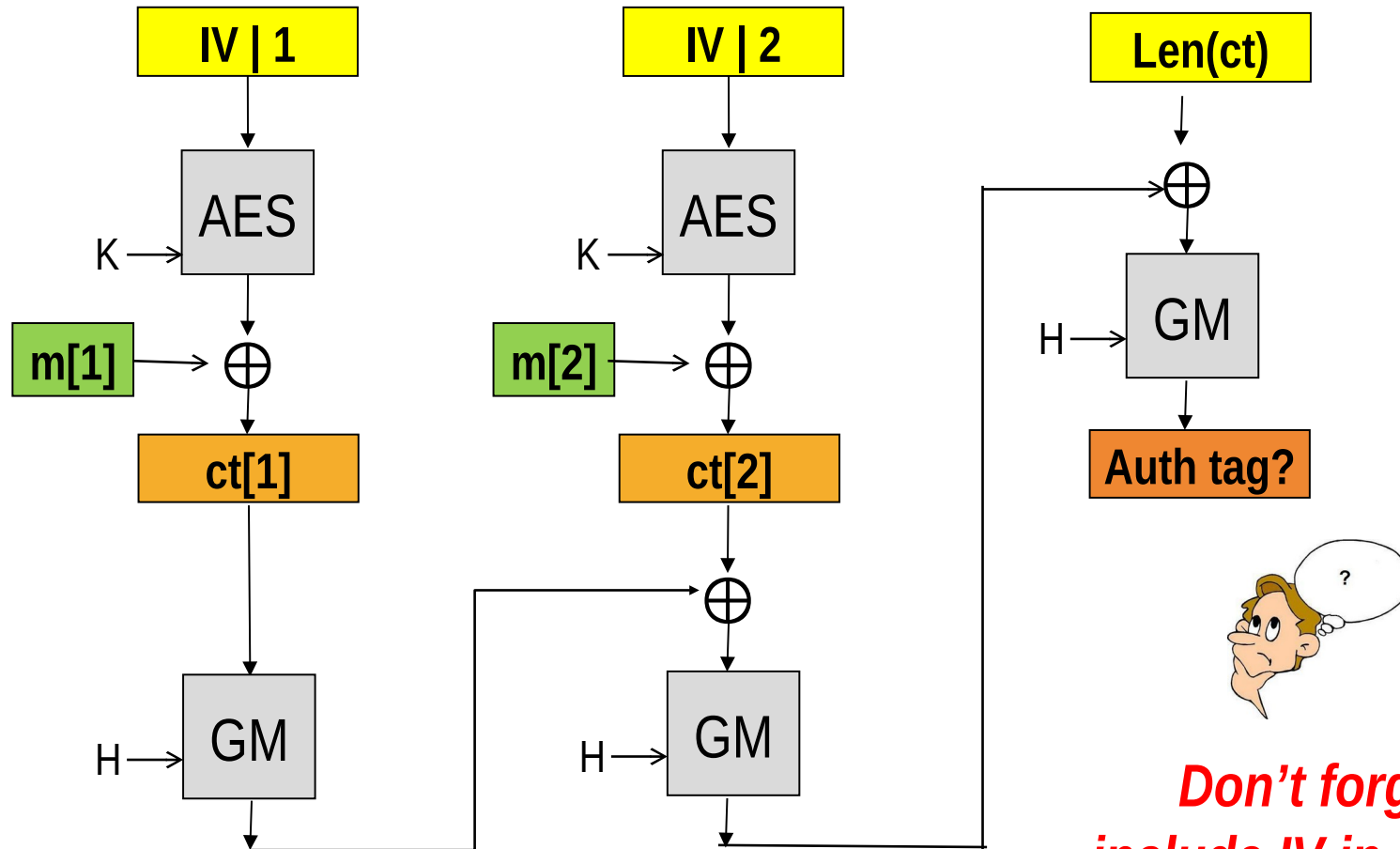
➔ **Encrypt-then-MAC structure**

- ⇒ Encrypt: AES-CTR (this is the CM – Counter Mode - in GCM)
- ⇒ MAC: GHASH (this is the G – Galois - in GCM)
 - ➔ Not a crypto hash, but a (much faster!) multiplication in $GF(2^{128})$ with an auth key
 - » more later

Construction @ high level (example: msg in two blocks)



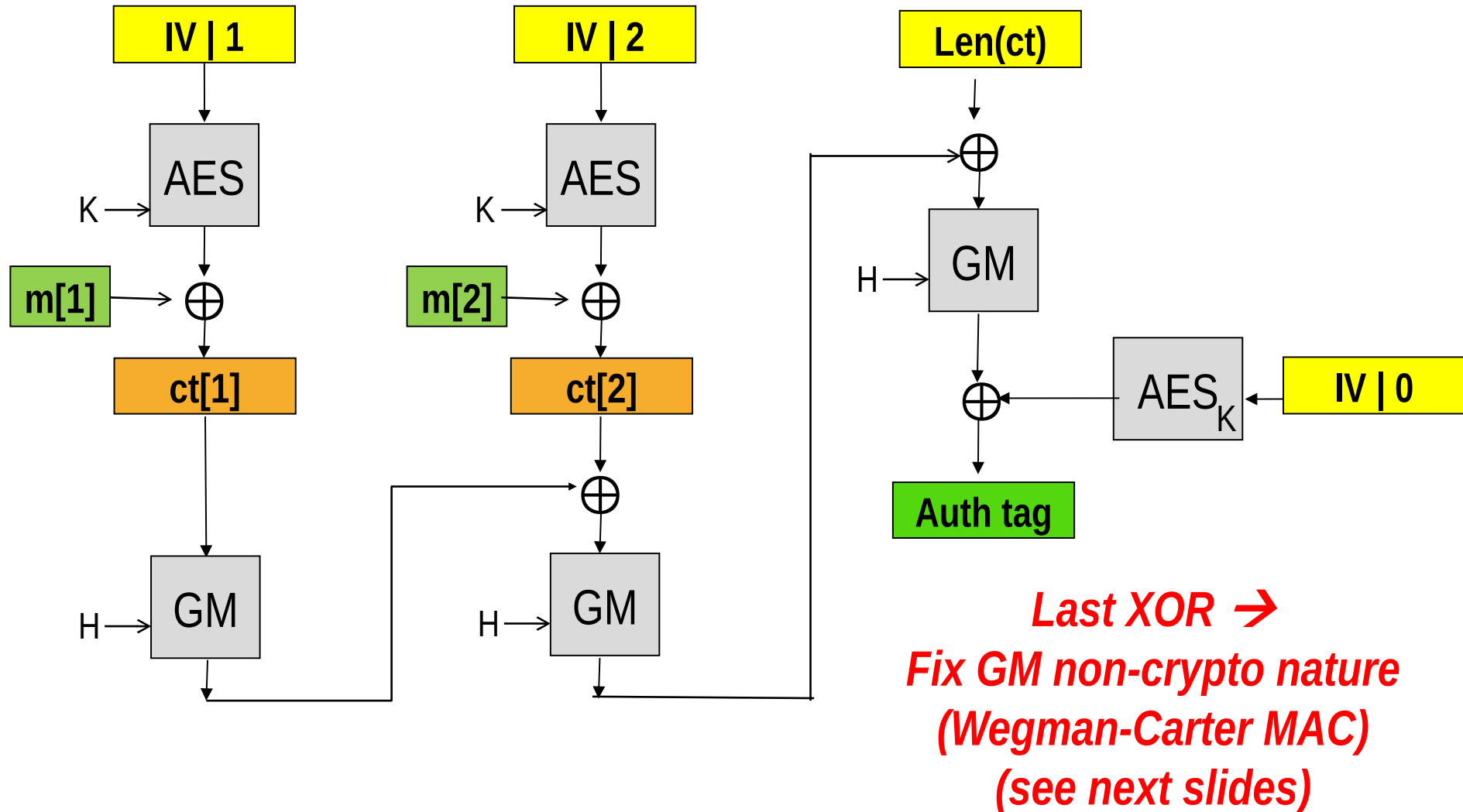
Construction @ high level (example: msg in two blocks)



**Don't forget to
include IV in auth tag!!**

(remember previous
CCA example against IV)

Construction @ high level (example: msg in two blocks)



Wegman-Carter MAC

- ➔ **Crypto hash are slow**
- ➔ **Non crypto hash can be a lot faster**
- ➔ **Wegman-Carter: how to MAC using NON-CRYPTO hash functions**
- ➔ **Two building blocks:**
 - ⇒ Universal Hash Function
 - ⇒ Pseudo Random Function

Universal Hash Function

→ **A Keyed Hash Function is a FAMILY of functions**

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Rightarrow & H_k(\text{msg}) \rightarrow \{0,1,\dots, m-1\} & \rightarrow k = \\ & \text{key} & \end{array}$$

→ **The family is «universal» if it is hard for an attacker which does NOT know the key to find a collision**

$$H_k(M_1) = H_k(M_2)$$

⇒ MANY differences with respect to crypto hash:

→ If you know the key, finding a collision CAN be easy

→ The output $H_k(M)$ may NOT be pseudo-random

→ **Companion property:**

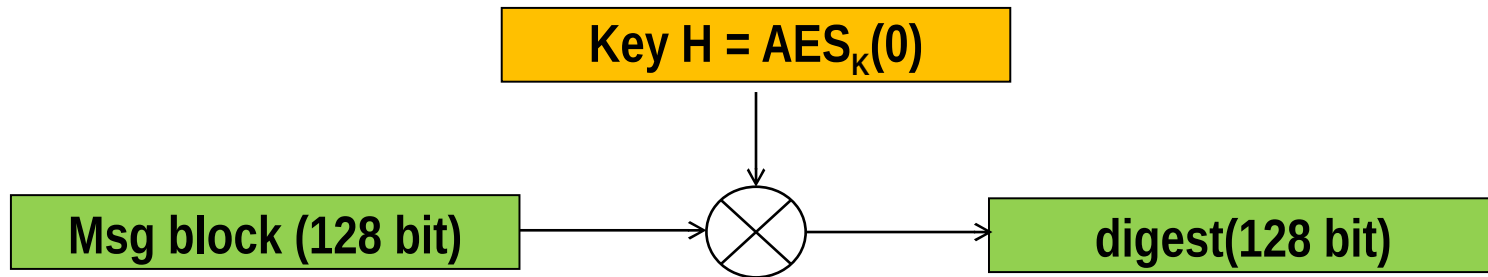
⇒ for any pair $x \neq y$, $\text{Prob} \{ H_x(M) = H_y(M) \} \leq 1/m$

→ Changing key should randomly change digest
(the probability that a collision repeats after changing key should be negligible)

→ there should be no pair $(M1, M2)$ that gives the same hash for many different keys.

AES-GCM: GHASH

→ GHASH is NOT crypto, but it is «just» a universal hash function



→ **Building block:**
Multiplication in $GF(2^{128})$

⇒ a.k.a. polynomial carry-less multiplication
→ CLMUL() instruction available in CPUs

Note: multiplication in $GF(2^n)$

→ Polynomial multiplication

⇒ Example $GF(2^4)$:

$$\rightarrow 1110 \times 1011 =$$

$$\rightarrow = (x^3 + x^2 + x) * (x^3 + x + 1) =$$

$$\rightarrow = x^6 + x^5 + 2x^4 + 2x^3 + 2x^2 + x = (\text{binary coeff: } 1+1 \rightarrow 0!)$$

$$\rightarrow = x^6 + x^5 + x = 01100010$$

⇒ Must now «reduce» to 4 bits: rest of division by «reduction» poly

→ Conceptually analogous to multiplication modulo prime # in standard arithmetics

⇒ Example $GF(2^4)$ using irreducible poly $x^4 + x + 1$:

$$\rightarrow (x^6 + x^5 + x) / (x^4 + x + 1) =$$

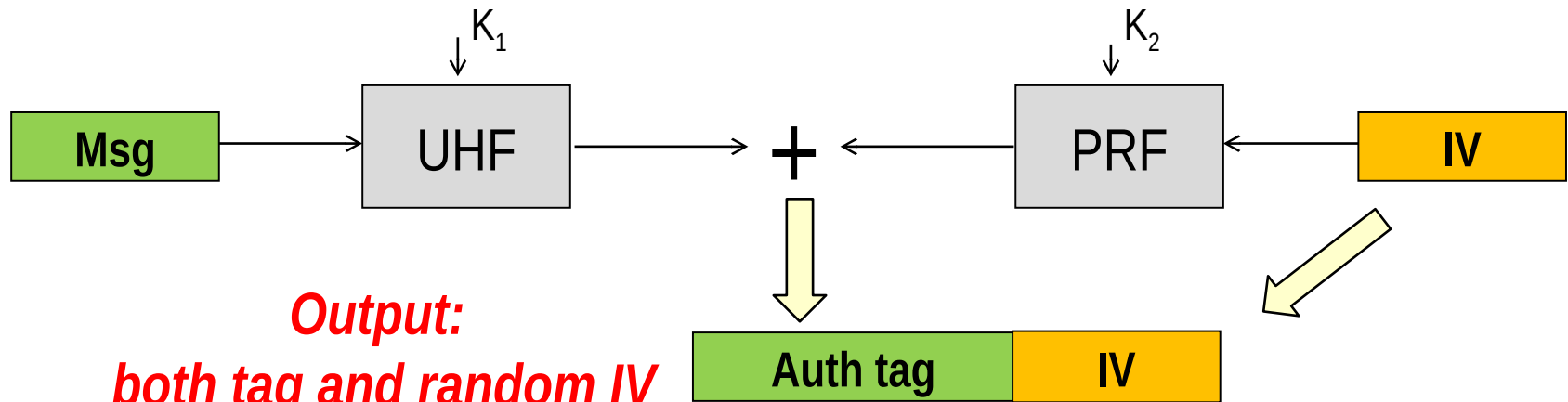
$$\rightarrow = x^2 + x + (-x^3 - 2x^2) / (x^4 + x + 1) = x^2 + x + (x^3) / (x^4 + x + 1)$$

$$\rightarrow \text{Result: rest of division: } x^3 = 1000$$

GHASH $GF(2^{128})$ irreducible poly used: $x^{128} + x^7 + x^2 + x + 1$

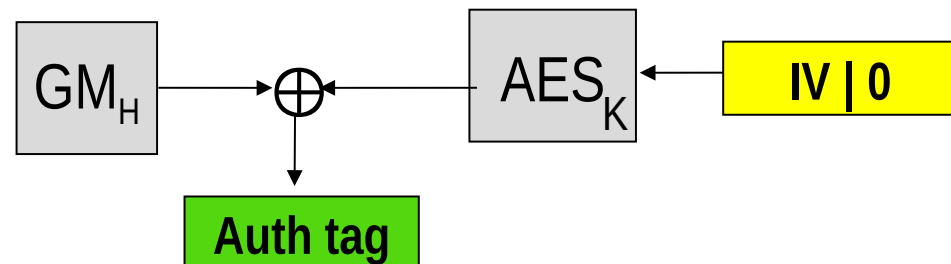
Wegman-Carter construction

→ A secure MAC can be constructed from an UHF and a PRF as $\text{UHF}_{k_1}(\text{msg}) + \text{PRF}_{k_2}(\text{rand})$

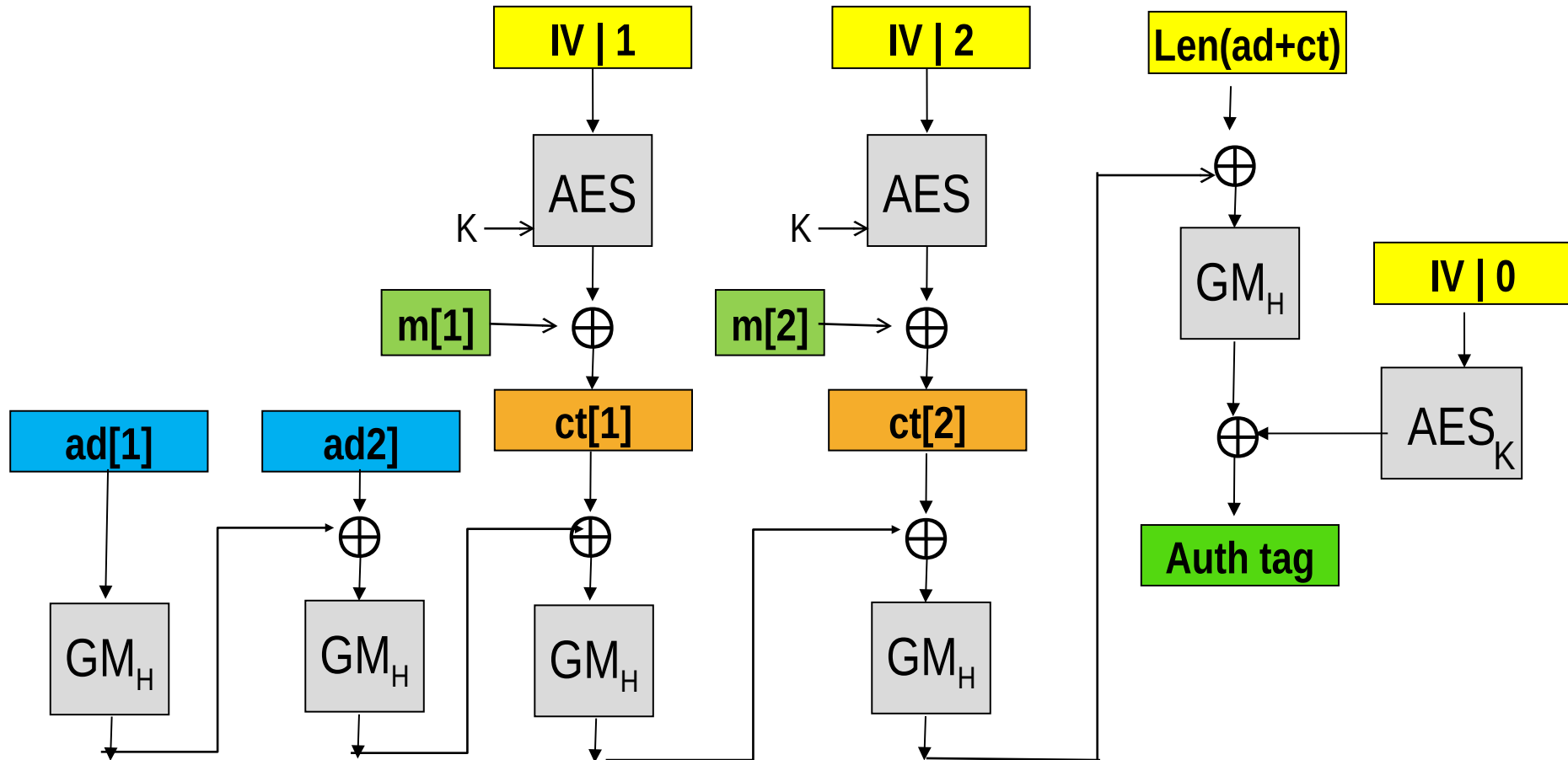


Output:
both tag and random IV
a new tool for you:
randomized MAC!

AES-GCM specific case:



What about Associated Data?



Len adjusted to include also associated data

GCM critical issue: nonce reuse

→ AES-GCM tag:

$$\Rightarrow \text{tag} = \text{GHASH}_H(\text{CT}) \oplus \text{AES}_K(\text{IV}, 0)$$

→ Nonce reused (same IV):

$$\Rightarrow \text{tag1} = \text{GHASH}_H(\text{CT1}) \oplus \text{AES}_K(\text{IV}, 0)$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{tag2} = \text{GHASH}_H(\text{CT2}) \oplus \text{AES}_K(\text{IV}, 0)$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{tag1} \oplus \text{tag2} = \text{GHASH}_H(\text{CT1}) \oplus \text{GHASH}_H(\text{CT2})$$

→ But GHASH is... linear (poly mult)!

⇒ Attacker can now recover auth key H,
and forge valid messages!

→ (Though at least encryption key K remains unknown...)

→ There exists some mode robust to nonce reuse?

⇒ Yes, AES-GCM-SIV (Synthetic IV), see RFC 8452, April 2019